
BBC LEARNING ENGLISH

Real Easy English

Technology



This is a transcript of a spoken conversation and is not a word-for-word script.

Beth

Hello and welcome to Real Easy English. In this podcast, we have real conversations in easy English to help you learn. I'm Beth.

Neil

And I'm Neil. Remember, you can read along with this podcast on our website: bbclearningenglish.com.

Beth

Hi, Neil. How are you? Neil are you checking your phone? We're recording!

Neil

Sorry, Beth. Yes, I'm just looking at my phone. I'm just checking the football scores. Finished now.

Beth

OK, good. Well, today we're talking all about **technology**.

Neil

Yes, and **technology** is what we call new things that we use to make life easier like phones, computers and the internet. We'll talk about new **technology** and how much we use it.

Beth

OK. Great. Well, let's get started. Now, Neil, you just said, "I'm checking my phone". That is the **present continuous** and you said it because you were checking the scores or checking your phone right then. Right at that moment.

But I have a question for you in the **present simple**, which is how often do you use **technology**?

Neil

So I use **technology** every day, many times every day. I check my phone a lot. I use a Bluetooth speaker. I sometimes play games with my son on his video console.

Beth

OK. So you use some **technology**.

Neil

I do, yes. How about you, Beth?

Beth

I read quite a lot on a tablet, so I do read some books, but I tend to use **technology** to read. And I have been learning Spanish, or I'm learning Spanish at the moment using an app on my phone. So I'm using **technology** for that a little bit.

Neil

And what's your favourite piece of **technology** that makes your life easy?

Beth

Well, I use a smoothie maker all the time. So, especially when I'm working from home, I chuck any old fruit and vegetables in there and make a smoothie.

What about you?

Neil

So, I've got a bread maker.

Beth

Ooh, that's cool.

Neil

Yeah and so I put all the ingredients together and in the morning we have lovely fresh bread.

Beth

Nice. Would you say that you are **tech-savvy**? Are you good at using new technology?

Neil

No, not at all! Eventually I learn the **technology**, but I never really get excited about new **technology** until lots of other people are already using it.

Beth

Yeah, I feel the same. I only really feel comfortable using **technology** when I have practised and got used to it.

Neil

Yeah. So, Beth, is there any new piece of **technology** that you would like to get that you don't have at the moment?

Beth

Well, I used to have a really good camera, but it's now about 10 years old. So, I think that **technology** has moved on quite a bit since then.

So, I'd quite like to get a really good new camera. But the camera's on phones are quite good these days, but it's always nice to have something really good for when you go on holiday and that sort of thing.

Neil

Let's recap some of the language we heard during the conversation.

We had **technology**, new scientific things that make our life easier, such as smartphones and computers.

Beth

Tech-savvy, good at using **technology**.

Neil

We learned to use the **present simple** to talk about our **technology** habits, things we always do. For example, I use my phone way too much.

Beth

And we learnt to use the **present continuous** to talk about things we're doing at this moment in time. For example, Neil, you are still checking the football scores!

Neil

I am. Sorry, Beth. But only because my home team is beating yours at football.

Beth

Yeah, yeah, yeah. Whatever!

Neil

That's it for this episode. If you want more easy English, try our video series, The London to Edinburgh Challenge. All episodes are available now on our website: bbclearningenglish.com

Beth

Next time on Real Easy English, we'll talk about our hobbies. Bye for now.

Neil

Bye!